P235/1

ISLAMIC RELIGIOUS EDUCATION

Paper 1

(Theory)

July /Aug 2026

3 Hours

AITEL JOINT MOCKS ASSESSMENTS 2026

Uganda Advanced Certificate of Education

ISLAMIC RELIGIOUS EDUCATION

PAPER 1

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES:

*This examination paper consists of two sections; **A** and **B**. It has four examination items.*

***Section A** has two compulsory items.*

***Section B** has two optional items. Respond to **one** item.*

*Respond to **three** items in all.*

Any additional item responded to will not be scored.

Begin each part of the item on a fresh page.

All responses must be written in the answer booklet(s) provided.

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SECTION A

*Respond to **both** items from this section.*

Item 1.

The Qur'an was revealed progressively over a period of 23 years, traversing two distinct geographical and political phases: the Makki phase in Makkah and the Madani phase in Madinah. These phases yielded distinctive stylistic features, thematic focuses, and legislative progressions, including the concept of *Naskh* (divine abrogation/gradual replacement of certain rulings), to systematically nurture the early Muslim community.

In a university Muslim students' symposium in Kampala, a group of undergraduate students raised questions regarding the structural differences in the Qur'an. Some students argued that the sharp contrast in tone and length between short, poetic verses and long, heavily legalistic chapters makes the text look inconsistent. Furthermore, a few non-Muslim peers attending the dialogue pointed out examples where earlier instructions (like the gradual prohibition of intoxicants) seem to contradict later absolute prohibitions, creating intellectual confusion among the Muslim youth about the wisdom behind changing divine rulings.

Equipping Muslim youth with an understanding of *Makki* and *Madani* classifications, along with the theological rationale behind *Naskh*, is vital to clear up misconceptions about textual consistency and demonstrate the pedagogical wisdom of the Qur'an.

Task:

(a) Examine the Islamic theological teachings on the characteristics of *Makki* and *Madani* revelations and the concept of *Naskh* to address the confusion highlighted in the scenario.

(b) Analyze the factors that make it difficult for contemporary youth in Uganda to appreciate the progressive and contextual nature of Qur'an-based legislation.

Item 2.

During a community youth seminar organized by a Muslim NGO in Masaka, the discussion centered on how Islamic law addresses fast-evolving global developments. The facilitator introduced a case regarding the use of advanced financial technologies, cryptocurrency, artificial intelligence, and new medical bioethics (such as organ donation and surrogacy). One participant remarked, *"Since these issues arose centuries after the completion of the Qur'an and Sunnah, ordinary believers are left without clear divine boundaries, making Sharia seem outdated."*

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In response, a local Islamic scholar clarified that when explicit texts (*Nass*) from the Qur'an and Hadith are silent on a novel matter, the legal framework of Islam utilizes secondary principles of jurisprudence—specifically *Ijma* (Scholarly Consensus) and *Maslaha Mursala* (Unprecedented Public Interest)—to formulate binding rulings that protect human life, intellect, and property. This explanation sparked an intense debate among the youth on how scholars determine what genuinely constitutes "public interest" without altering the core principles of faith.

Task:

(a) Examine the guidance that the principles of *Ijma* and *Maslaha Mursala* provide to the youth in the scenario to address modern technological and ethical dilemmas.

(b) Discuss the intellectual and social values that contemporary Ugandan students can develop by engaging with the comprehensive framework of Islamic jurisprudence (*Fiqh*).

SECTION B

*Respond to **one** item from this section.*

Item 3.

The Qur'an outlines precise legal boundaries regarding the validity of marriage contracts and guards the financial independence of women within the domestic sphere. In Surah Al-Nisa 4:4, Allah commands: *"And give the women [upon marriage] their lawful dowry (Mahr) graciously. But if they, of their own volition, give up any part of it to you, then take it and enjoy it with wholesome appetite."*

Further structural boundaries regarding marital choices are detailed in Surah Al-Nisa 4:23, which lists the absolute prohibitions (*Tahrim*) based on consanguinity, affinity, and fosterage: *"Prohibited to you [for marriage] are your mothers, your daughters, your sisters, your father's sisters, your mother's sisters, your brother's daughters, your sister's daughters, your [foster] mothers who nursed you..."*

These foundational texts protect the integrity of the family structure and guarantee that a woman's marital consent is backed by her own financial security.

Task:

(a) Examine the ways in which the selected Qur'anic guidelines on *Mahr* (dowry) and *Tahrim* (prohibited degrees of marriage) secure the social and financial rights of family members.

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(b) Analyse the social and psychological dangers that a Muslim community faces when it disregards these specific legislative regulations on dowry and prohibited relationships.

Item 4.

Islamic family law provides clear structures for conflict resolution and mechanisms for women seeking release from incompatible marriages, while also defining wealth distribution upon a relative's demise. In Surah Al-Baqarah 2:229, Allah addresses the concept of *Khul'* (divorce initiated by the wife through mutual financial settlement): *"...And it is not lawful for you to take anything of what you have given them unless both fear that they will not keep [within] the limits of Allah. But if you fear that they will not keep the limits of Allah, there is no blame upon either of them concerning that by which she ransoms herself..."*

Furthermore, to prevent disputes over material wealth within families, the Qur'an sets forth immutable inheritance boundaries (*Mirath*). In Surah Al-Nisa 4:11, Allah commands: *"Allah instructs you concerning your children: for the male, what is equal to the share of two females. But if there are [only] daughters, two or more, for them is two thirds of one's estate. And if there is only one, for her is half..."*

Task:

(a) Examine the ways in which the teachings on *Khul'* and *Mirath* in the above Qur'anic texts aim to establish justice and prevent exploitation within family relations.

(b) Analyse the practical challenges contemporary Muslims encounter when trying to correctly implement these legal provisions for female-initiated divorce and estate distribution.

END

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